Pics from [Hericium erinaceus - Wikipedia]() and [Lion's Mane Mist & Grow Kit - Grow Mushrooms Canada]()

Hericium erinaceus, more commonly known as Lions Mane mushroom. This mushroom looks funny because it has dangling spines instead of gills for producing spores. Despite its funny looks, it is a highly prized edible mushroom with medicinal properties. Ancient Chinese medical practitioners used this mushroom to heighten brain function and memory. This mushroom can be easily cultivated indoors as well. Due to its light and fluffy texture, and its thin splines, this mushroom is really good at absorbing sauces and flavors when cooked. This mushroom is commonly found in mushroom supplements.

These mushrooms are commonly growing in clusters found on dying or dead hardwood/deciduous trees. Most commonly on maple, ash, oaks, and eucalyptus. Though they can be found on living trees, they are not parasitic. They are growing on the tree because the tree is dying, and these mushrooms are decomposing it. These mushrooms are very beneficial to the forest ecosystem because they decompose dead trees quickly so they can return back to the soil and revitalize it further. They are most commonly found on dead and decaying trees.

[Hericium erinaceus - Wikipedia]()

Never consume mushrooms you aren't 100% sure of! This quick writeup is meant to be informative. If you wish to find and consume mushrooms from the wild, ensure you have the correct mushroom. I am not responsible if you attempt to eat a mushroom that looks like a mushroom from this pack, as there can be potentially many different poisonous lookalikes. If you wish to do your own mushroom hunting, check out some mushroom guide books local to your area (ie A Field Guide To Edible Mushrooms Of The Pacific Northwest if you live in the PNW). You can also try to find local guides who do mushroom hunts where you can learn more about mushrooms in your area.